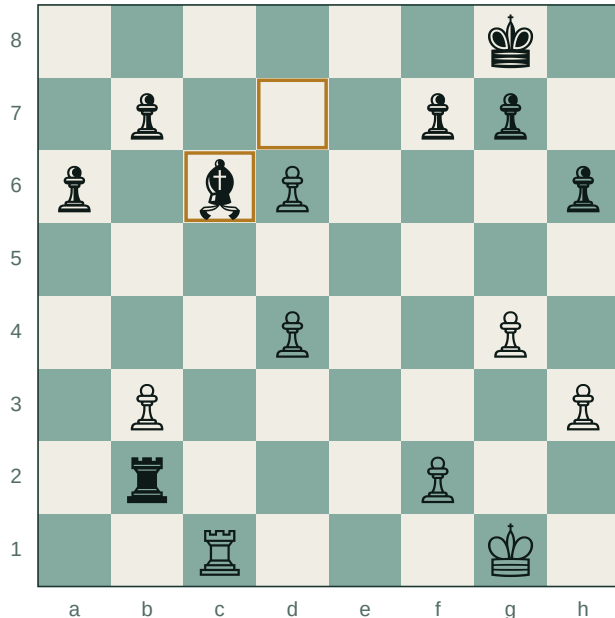


Advanced-pawn tactics: White, move 29

Advanced-pawn tactics

White to move



Previous move: 28...Bc6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

29. Rxc6 bxc6 30. d7

29.Rxc6 The rook captures the bishop on c6. Recorded reply: **29...bxc6**.

30.d7 The pawn moves from d6 to d7.

At the end, nominal material is White 6 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -2: the balance goes from -2 to -4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on b2. Check for tactical protection.